Putting self-interest to work for the public good

An application of the Decentralized Curation framework

Speaker script

The handout leads the session's title and scope. This script accompanies the presentation deck. Slide numbers match the deck. Read the spoken paragraphs naturally; bracketed directions are private delivery cues. The slides supply a picture, a question or a result while the explanation comes from you.

The eighty-minute schedule matches the facilitator guide. Timing includes demonstrations, audience answers and quiet scoring time, not continuous speech. Protect the game's scoring window. If joining or recovery takes longer, shorten a later discussion explicitly rather than rush participants through an active round. The deck has 24 logical slides. Its offline export has the same 24 pages: the number and curation rounds occupy slides 7 and 8, each before its reveal. The opening establishes purpose-specific, multidimensional information quality and the trust required for curation, then uses game theory and a brief two-round Schelling-point exercise and a feedback loop to introduce the framework before applying it to public goods funding. Source links and technical answers remain in the private notes; follow-up codes are on the handout.

Use the live values on screen if a slider changes them. Default numerical checkpoints below describe the reset example only. The deck owns those inputs; the shared policy, session information, facilitator guide and source register remain the detailed references.

1. Putting self-interest to work for the public good

Target: 1 minute. Elapsed: 0:00 to 0:01.

“Today I want to start with a problem we all share: there is more information than we can personally check, yet our decisions depend on what we learn from it.

“Decentralized Curation is a proposal for organizing that work. Can we make producing, assessing and correcting useful information rewarding to the people doing it, so others can make better decisions?

“I have worked on this framework since 2021. We will define the problem, examine the proposed solution, apply it to public goods funding and then experience one part of it together.

“Thank you to Octant for sponsoring this session.”

[Let the title settle. Keep the funding application for later; first establish why anyone needs curation.]

2. Information becomes useful when it is fit for purpose

Target: 1 minute 30 seconds. Elapsed: 0:01 to 0:02:30.

“Information quality depends on the user, the task and the context. Curation assesses fitness for use through four lenses: intrinsic, contextual, representational and accessibility. Accurate information can still be outdated, irrelevant or unusable.

“Academic work depends on this: journals, peer review, systematic reviews and research databases help determine which findings we can rely on and what those findings mean. Their assessments shape attention, credibility and resource allocation.

“The useful question is therefore not simply how much information we have. It is whether we have information sufficiently accurate, relevant and usable for the decision in front of us. The foundational paper calls this decision-grade knowledge.”

[Use one academic example. Establish the purpose before discussing quality; information can be useful for one decision and unsuitable for another.]

3. Information quality is multidimensional

Target: 1 minute 30 seconds. Elapsed: 0:02:30 to 0:04.

“Accuracy is one dimension of information quality. A perfectly accurate football result can be irrelevant to a decision about research infrastructure. A relevant study can still be outdated or omit essential context.

“Relevance, timeliness, completeness, interpretability and accessibility answer different questions. Which dimensions matter, and how demanding we should be about each, depends on the purpose. Quality is not a single number that means the same thing everywhere.

“Curation therefore begins by specifying what qualities we seek. In our funding example, we will assess factual accuracy separately from relevance to the pool’s goal. Evidence supports both assessments, but a high relevance score does not certify a factual claim, and a correct fact does not establish its importance.”

[Point to the six dimensions, then return to accuracy and relevance. Do not introduce a universal aggregate quality score.]

4. Curation creates reliance on the curator

Target: 1 minute 30 seconds. Elapsed: 0:04 to 0:05:30.

“Curation is essential because none of us can examine every claim ourselves. Delegating that work saves effort and gives us access to other people’s expertise. It also makes us rely on three qualities of the curator.

“Honesty means reporting an assessment sincerely. Competence means knowing how to assess the subject. Scrutiny means investing effort in critically examining claims, evidence and plausible alternatives.

“These qualities are distinct. A sincere person can be mistaken; an expert can report strategically; either can accept a plausible claim without examining it. Good curation needs all three.

“The design opportunity is to support that trust with incentives, inspectable evidence and opportunities for correction. How can the institution make careful, competent and honest assessment worth doing?”

[Keep the three qualities distinct. The proposal organizes and supports trust; it does not make trust unnecessary.]

5. Who should curate?

Target: 1 minute 30 seconds. Elapsed: 0:05:30 to 0:07.

“A central curator can bring expertise, a consistent editorial purpose and fast decisions. The difficulty is dependence on that curator: limited capacity, blind spots and incentives can shape what everyone else sees. We need ways to inspect and contest those judgments.

“A simple vote opens participation and tells us something about people’s preferences. Counting votes alone does not gather evidence or make every voter informed about the subject. Popularity is not the same as accuracy or relevance to a stated goal.

“These are not exhaustive descriptions of institutions. Democratic processes can include expert advice, deliberation and scrutiny; specialists can learn from the people affected by their decisions.

“The design challenge is to combine participation with informed, inspectable and correctable judgment. Opening entry is only one part of that. It does not guarantee equal influence or representation of everyone affected, and experts do not acquire the right to decide public purposes just by being experts.”

[Ask which part of the challenge a familiar system handles well. Do not frame the proposal as a proven replacement for democracy or professional expertise.]

6. Incentives shape strategic behavior

Target: 1 minute 30 seconds. Elapsed: 0:07 to 0:08:30.

“Game theory gives us a useful way to design this institution. Specify the rewards, the costs, the available strategies and what participants know. Then ask which behavior becomes attractive when people respond to one another.

“Reward submission volume and producing more submissions becomes attractive. Reward agreement and anticipating other people’s answers becomes attractive. If we want useful curation, we need the rewards to make informed assessment and correction attractive after the work they require.

“The game aims to make honesty, competence and scrutiny the most rewarding way to participate. That is a design objective to analyze and test. Rewards alone do not determine outcomes: information, expectations, effort and the surrounding rules matter.

“One powerful idea here is that people can coordinate their expectations without a binding agreement. Communication may help them identify a shared focal point.”

[Use incentives as an analytical tool, not a claim that a reward formula proves the desired behavior. Silence is a rule of this exercise, not a requirement for a Schelling point. A trusted or enforceable collusive agreement can coordinate behavior around another strategy; communication alone does not establish such an agreement. Move directly into the coordination exercise.]

7. Find a shared focal point

Target: 35 seconds. Elapsed: 0:08:30 to 0:09:05.

“Look at these forty-nine numbers. Silently choose the number you expect others here to choose. Your aim is to match them. Do not say it yet.”

[Give five seconds. The seven-by-seven grid places 100 in the center with a gentle blue tint; all numbers use the same font and weight. Do not name these cues or point to 100. Participants use no controls or devices.]

“On three, say your number together. One, two, three.”

[Listen to the room, then select **Reveal example**. Do not invent vote totals. If no clear answer emerges, say: “We did not converge on one answer this time.”]

“One hundred sits in the center. It is the only even number, the only round hundred, and has a gentle blue tint. These cues converge on one option. I notice it, and I expect you to notice it. That is a Schelling point.”

8. Choose a way of playing

Target: 55 seconds. Elapsed: 0:09:05 to 0:10.

“Now choose the way of playing you expect everyone else to choose. Keep it to yourself until three.”

[Advance to slide 8 with Next, Space or the right arrow. Give five seconds to read the eight combinations of honest or deceptive, competent or uninformed, and thorough or lazy. Honest · Competent · Thorough has a gentle blue tint and darker text, like 100; do not point it out before hearing the room. Then count to three and hear the answers before selecting **Reveal example** again.]

“Honest, competent and thorough stand out as a shared standard for how to play. Thorough means critically examining claims and evidence: scrutiny. We know these qualities matter for curation, and we expect others to recognize them too.

“The design challenge is to make acting on these qualities the most rewarding way to participate. Naming a focal point illustrates coordination; the incentives must make it worth following.”

[Reveal emphasizes the intended focal option and explains it; it does not report audience votes. Each slide has its own **Reset game** control, restoring the gentle tint for each round’s focal choice. Normal navigation preserves each slide’s reveal state when revisited. If either round has scattered answers, acknowledge that rather than claiming consensus. Advance to slide 9 for the incentive loop.]

9. Expectations can reinforce good judgment

Target: 30 seconds. Elapsed: 0:10 to 0:10:30.

“Here is the feedback loop. I expect others to judge honestly, competently and thoroughly. I want to earn rewards by being coherent with their judgments. So I judge honestly, competently and thoroughly too.

“Coherence means agreement between judgments. The design goal is to make informed judgment the most rewarding route to that agreement.”

[This is conditional reasoning: informed assessment must outperform cheap prediction or coordinated error after effort and other costs. The slide illustrates the intended incentive loop, not a proven best response or guarantee of sound judgment.]

10. A framework before a mechanism

Target: 1 minute 30 seconds. Elapsed: 0:10:30 to 0:12.

“The foundational paper proposes four design steps.

“First, define the problem. Which decision is suffering, and is missing or poor information actually part of the cause?

“Second, identify the qualities that matter for that decision. We should not assume every domain needs the same score.

“Third, ask where challenges make sense. They help only when a claim can be falsified and finding decisive counter-evidence is feasible and cheaper than exhaustively verifying everything. A fact that anyone can check instantly may need no elaborate dispute system.

“Fourth, choose a mechanism for each quality. A factual challenge and a judgment of relevance do different jobs. We should not force them into one signal.

“Decentralized Curation is this broader framework. The paper develops news as an application. Today we will use public goods funding, with its own purpose and policy. We want credible consensus: judgments grounded in evidence, assessed under an explicit policy and open to useful correction.”

[Trace the four steps in order. Leave the funding workflow for slide 11.]

11. Apply the framework to public goods funding

Target: 2 minutes. Elapsed: 0:12 to 0:14.

“Let us apply those steps. Our decision is which public contributions to support. A group defines the goal, judging criteria, required evidence and assessor rewards. Together, these form its policy. A pool applies that policy to nominations.

“A person nominates work, supplies checkable claims and evidence, identifies a beneficiary and puts down a deposit backing those claims. A jury assesses relevance under the policy. People can challenge the claims, fund an appeal of a score and reassess relevance later.

“The assessment produces relative weights. A funding budget can use them to allocate support, and that budget can arrive after the curation. Funding is one use of the assessment, rather than the definition of the framework.

“The process distributes judgment and checking. It still depends on sound criteria, accessible evidence and credible arbitration. Now we will follow one example so those roles become concrete.”

[Trace funders → pool → beneficiaries first. Then show who supplies the assessment: nominators bring claims and evidence, jurors judge relevance, and fact-checkers take factual disputes to an external arbitrator. The creator publishes the policy. Continuous funding does not remove per-nomination jury and appeal rounds.]

12. Set the policy; nominate checkable work

Target: 2 minutes. Elapsed: 0:14 to 0:16.

“Our example goal is to support open infrastructure that research depends on. How much does the nominee’s completed and maintained work underpin how research is done, shared and kept, now? We consider who relies on it, its role and the alternatives, supported by evidence of use, costs and limitations.

“This is a choice for this pool. Publishing the policy makes it inspectable; it does not settle whose needs it includes or misses. Another pool may choose a different goal.

“Our nominee is NumPy, the array library used in scientific Python. Its version 2.0.0 was released on 16 June 2024. We can check that against the release record. Establishing the date does not establish how much the work matters under our criteria.

“The release record is real. This nomination, its scores and its funding are illustrative. This is not an actual application by NumPy.”

[Read the scoring question once, then point from the dated claim to the published release announcement. Ask which relevance criterion the release date alone can answer.]

Source for this example: NumPy release record. Keep the link in the notes for questions rather than projecting it.

13. Jurors score independently

Target: 2 minutes. Elapsed: 0:16 to 0:18.

“People put down a deposit to enter the draw for paid jury work. Their stake is capital they can lose. More available stake increases their chance of being drawn. Here six drawn seats are held by three jurors: more seats do not necessarily mean more independent people.

“Each juror reads the evidence and privately seals a score before revealing it. The technical name is commit and reveal. These controls show scores after revelation. The result is the weighted mean; more drawn weight gives a juror more influence.

“Watch what happens when I move one score.”

[Move one slider and pause.]

“The calculation changes predictably. To decide whether the judgment improved, we need the reason and the evidence, not just the new number.”

[Ask what evidence could justify the change. Reset the example to its starting values before advancing. Keep the limitations of sealing for slide 23.]

14. Curate the shares; distribution can follow

Target: 2 minutes. Elapsed: 0:18 to 0:20.

“Think of one whole budget being divided into shares. The table shows each contribution’s weight, its share of the total and the funding that share receives. At the reset values, NumPy has weight 0.60 out of a total of 1.50. That is a 40 percent share, not 60 percent of the budget.

“Set funding to zero: the shares remain. Add 100 units per day, and NumPy’s share receives 40.”

[Set funding to zero, then restore 100. Point to the unchanged shares and changed amounts.]

“We have curated an assessment that can exist before a funding budget. Curation itself has costs, even when beneficiary funding arrives later. These weights express judgments under this policy, not measured public benefit.”

[Ask: “If one weight rises and the budget stays fixed, whose share changes?” Take a brief answer.]

15. Contest a score through an appeal

Target: 2 minutes. Elapsed: 0:20 to 0:22.

“Suppose people think the assessment missed something important. Anyone can help fund a proposed score, including the person who nominated the work. Competing, fully funded proposals trigger a larger jury.

“Here the jury grows from six seats to twelve. It examines the same nomination and reaches its own judgment. Let us apply this illustrative result.”

[Select **Apply appeal result**. Read the result on the current slide.]

“The adopted score and funding shares change. An appeal gives people a route to contest a judgment. More seats do not automatically mean more knowledge: correction still needs evidence, independent assessment and funding.”

[Ask what evidence they would want the appeal jury to consider. Keep settlement rules in the private questions below.]

16. Challenge a factual claim

Target: 2 minutes. Elapsed: 0:22 to 0:24.

“Now take a different kind of disagreement. Imagine the nomination says: ‘NumPy 2.0.0 was released in 2020.’ The release record says 16 June 2024. That gives a fact-checker evidence for a claim challenge, not a reason to argue about the relevance score.

“Anyone can challenge a claim as false or untestable while its nomination is active. An external arbitrator decides. A successful fact-checker receives the submitter’s deposit and the nomination ends. The reward gives people a reason to look for errors, but it works only if investigation and reliable adjudication are feasible.”

[Select **Show debunked outcome**. Read the result on the current slide.]

“Future funding stops. What the nomination already earned remains owed to its beneficiary. The submitter can make a fresh nomination.

“The 2020 claim is invented for this demonstration. It is not an accusation against NumPy.”

[Ask where the reward comes from. A lack of challenges alone is not evidence that every claim was checked.]

17. Reassess when circumstances change

Target: 1 minute. Elapsed: 0:24 to 0:25.

“A contribution can remain accurately described while its relevance changes. Alternatives improve; reliance grows or shrinks. Periodic reassessment runs a fresh scoring round. An appeal contests an existing score, while reassessment asks again in the current context.

“This is a separate branch of the example. I am restoring the original nomination and applying an illustrative lower assessment.”

[Select **Apply lower assessment**.]

“The new weight changes future funding; earlier earnings stay earned. We now have three different correction paths: challenge a claim, appeal a judgment or reassess it later. Let us experience the judgment part ourselves.”

18. Join the workshop

Target: 3 minutes. Elapsed: 0:25 to 0:28.

“Scan the code or open the room address. Use an alias and take a seat. You do not need an account or wallet; we are using points.

“Every round gives each seat the same weight, regardless of earlier wins or losses. This exercise lets us examine scoring incentives; it cannot test whether stake losses select better jurors.

“Your alias, revealed scores and standings will be visible to this room. Some rounds may give you an optional adversarial role. You can decline that role, sit out a nominee or simply observe. Please ask people before photographing or sharing identifiable results.

“I will wipe the room records after our discussion. The room does not automatically expire, and that wipe does not remove credentials or sealed-score proofs stored on your own device.

“Keep your device awake when we reveal. For now, read the policy before taking your first scoring decision.”

[Compare seats with participants. Remove duplicate or stray seats before opening the first nominee. Do not put private host controls on the projector.]

19. Use one shared policy

Target: 2 minutes. Elapsed: 0:28 to 0:30.

“Our question is the same one from the example: how much does this nominee’s completed and maintained work underpin how research is done, shared and kept, now?

“Consider reliance, its role in research and available alternatives. Keep your personal taste, your own field and who runs or funds the project separate from that assessment. A completed contribution can still matter greatly today.

“Score the work actually nominated. If two nominations claim the same underlying work, we should not credit that same work twice. Distinct contributions by the same beneficiary can still count separately.

“The anchors give us a common language, not measured truths. We are using short descriptions and our prior knowledge today, without a common evidence dossier. You may sit out if you lack enough information, or for any other reason. This is an exercise in how judgment and incentives interact, not a rigorous evaluation of these projects.”

[Read the anchor labels together. Invite one clarification about the policy. Avoid announcing which nominee should score highest.]

20. See what the workshop rewards

Target: 2 minutes. Elapsed: 0:30 to 0:32.

“The scores we submit produce a group result. Around it is a reward zone. Every seat counts equally in this workshop.

“Inside that zone, scores closer to the group result receive a larger share of the points. Outside it, scores lose points, with larger losses further away. If everyone gives the same score, there are no distance penalties.

“Watch the reward zone when I move one score.”

[Move a dot, then reset. Let the audience describe what changed.]

“Your score helps shape the result against which you and everyone else are rewarded. That can draw attention to the shared question; it can also reward a shared mistake.

“Relevance scores guide support for contributions; juror rewards pay the people assessing them. This workshop uses points to let us experience those incentives.”

21. Play the jury

Target: 27 minutes. Elapsed: 0:32 to 0:59.

“For each nominee, read the description, apply the policy and seal your own score. Keep the two secret words used to seal your score private. When I close scoring, keep this page open so your device can reveal. You can change your seal before closing, or sit the nominee out.

“Before opening each round, I will announce the grading cutoff and leave time for sleeping phones to reconnect and reveal. Once I grade, a later reveal cannot change that round’s result.”

[Play the six default nominees in the order shown by the room. Allow roughly four and a half minutes each: quiet scoring first, then recovery and grading, followed by ninety seconds of discussion. Do not shorten an active scoring window.]

After each result, ask:

“Which piece of evidence or part of the policy most affected your score?”

[Hear one higher and one lower assessment when time permits. Then point to the outcome.]

“What did this rule reward in the reports we actually received?”

[Do not call paid jurors correct or forfeiting jurors incompetent. Record interesting differences for the debrief instead of resolving every one now. Do not announce the privately recorded comparison before all the compared rounds finish.]

If proof reporting needs explanation, say:

“A sealed-score proof contains the score and its two words. Another seated juror can report a valid proof during scoring for a bounty; the disclosing juror loses points. This concerns disclosing the proof, not discussing the policy.”

[For the assigned-role round, let the interface deliver the private instruction. Participants may decline it. Do not identify roles publicly before the result. If nobody reveals, explain that the round is void; do not infer a judgment from it.]

22. What shaped the scores?

Target: 5 minutes. Elapsed: 0:59 to 1:04.

“Now let us interpret what happened. Where did the policy guide us, and where did expectations about other people guide us? What evidence explained a high score or a low one? Did we disagree about the facts, the policy’s scope, or the available alternatives?”

[Hear two or three explanations. Reveal the privately recorded comparison now, including any mismatch with the observed results.]

“The group result and spread describe these reports, without explaining them. Scores near zero or one have less room to vary. A wider reward zone alone does not establish deeper disagreement.

“In the assigned-role round, compare the people assigned a role, the scores actually submitted and the points actually earned. Being assigned a role is not the same as following it. Following an instruction is not evidence that money caused manipulation. A matching score does not tell us someone’s motive.

“Let us use the widget to examine how a coordinated group can move the group result.”

[Move the bloc control gradually. State the displayed configuration; do not announce a universal safe percentage.]

“The group can sometimes move the result against which everyone is rewarded. A minority can also have a good argument and lose. This is why coherence alone cannot certify accuracy. One room and one simulated group do not establish resistance to capture.”

23. Attack the mechanism

Target: 5 minutes. Elapsed: 1:04 to 1:09.

“Now let us examine where the defenses could fail.

“A published policy gives us shared criteria, but the criteria can still be ambiguous or misguided.

“Private scoring makes copying harder while scores remain hidden. Early disclosure exposes a score before others finish. Sealing does not prevent people from coordinating privately or buying votes.

“Deposits put a juror’s money at risk, but concentrated stake can still concentrate influence. A large deposit alone does not demonstrate competence.

“An appeal allows another hearing, but it needs funding and useful evidence. A larger jury can still share the same bias.

“This workshop adds a penalty and reward for reporting proof of a disclosed score. That particular rule belongs to this exercise. A vote buyer may have other ways to check compliance.

“Choose one of these attacks. What would the attacker do, and what would the defense need to stop it?”

[Use the remaining time for one concrete attack and response. Ask what weakness remains. Keep contract comparisons, payout rules and recovery machinery in the private notes.]

24. Close the loop

Target: 11 minutes. Elapsed: 1:09 to 1:20.

“We began with a problem: our decisions depend on information that we cannot all inspect for ourselves. The proposal is open participation supported by honesty, competence and scrutiny. Personal rewards should make useful curation worthwhile for the people doing it, while their assessments help others make better decisions.

“We explored public-goods curation, with funding as one use of its results. What would make this useful in your work, and what would make you hesitate to rely on it?”

[Use about two minutes for the recap and first responses. Keep the remaining time conversational.]

[From 1:11 to 1:18, invite questions. If the room is quiet, choose one prompt at a time:]

- [“What is the difference between challenging a claim, appealing a score and reassessing later?” Ask a participant to explain before adding anything.]
- [“Where would informed judgment make a difference in your work? What evidence would those jurors need?”]
- [“What would show us that the rewards improved judgment, rather than simply producing agreement?”]
- [“Who would benefit from the resulting decisions? Whose needs might our criteria miss?”]

[Use a concrete example from the audience. Keep detailed mechanism questions brief and offer the private source notes for follow-up. Do not fill the time with a second lecture.]

[At about 1:18, bring the discussion back to the central idea.]

“We need two separate results: rewards must make useful investigation worth doing, and the decisions must improve outcomes for the people affected. Agreement and profit alone establish neither.

“Your handout has the codes to read the framework preprint and stay in touch. Please bring me both use cases and counterexamples. Thank you.”

[Leave the closing slide visible for questions and point people to the handout codes. Finish the game if necessary so final standings remain available. After the discussion, wipe room records as promised and verify that the wipe succeeded.]

Private reference: source scope

Use these notes for source questions; there is no corresponding projected slide.

“The sources have different roles. The opening four-step framework, multidimensional account of information quality and incentive hypothesis come from the published paper, which records the research at a particular release. The source register identifies later working choices. The inspected implementation snapshot supports statements about that code, not a claim that those contracts are deployed, audited or identical to the paper.

“The Arrow proposal supports the experiment’s stated scope. It does not supply results. Some implementation and proposal sources are access-controlled, so the public explanation states what was inspected and where independent access is limited.

“If a source seems to contradict today’s explanation, first check which version and which system it describes.”

References: published version 1.2.0, published manuscript source, Schelling’s original coordination examples, inspected implementation snapshot, Arrow experiment proposal, public mechanism summary, full source register, proposed evaluation plan.

Private reference: questions to answer without loading the slides

These are optional answers, not another presentation segment. The source register retains the detailed rules and their evidence boundaries.

How do the funding weights and juror rewards differ?

“The example’s funding weight is the smaller of the requested cap and the adopted relevance score. The cap is a ceiling, not a promised share. Normalize the eligible positive weights to obtain the shares. One positive weight receives the whole share; no positive weights means there is no allocation yet.

“A jury-issued relevance score is a weighted mean. An unopposed funded proposal can instead supply an adopted score by forfeiture, without another jury. Juror rewards are a separate calculation. The workshop’s group result is a mean and its reward zone uses standard deviation, with a zero-spread fallback. The inspected implementation instead grades reports against the final jury’s weighted median and median absolute deviation, with a configured floor.

“In the intended working design, ether (ETH) pays a fixed service fee per eligible revealed seat when a valid ruling is issued. A separate utility token provides jury stake and the redistribution of incoherence penalties. If nobody loses utility tokens, there are no extra tokens to redistribute. The service fee is separate from that coherence result.”

See the grading comparison for the model and version boundaries.

What does score sealing protect, and where does it fall short?

“Sealing binds a later revealed score to its earlier commitment. The inspected contract permits an early reveal while other people can still commit, so it does not fully prevent copying. Private coordination, bribery and other ways to prove compliance remain possible. The workshop’s proof-reporting penalty is an exercise rule; no corresponding reporting path was found in that inspected contract snapshot.”

Is there an authority that can stop funding?

“The inspected funding implementation has a configured, time-limited authority that can permanently stop future accrual once. That holder cannot take funding already accrued. This is an implementation-specific governance choice, not a claim that such authority follows from the framework.”

How do public appeal positions settle?

“Anyone can back a score position, including the nominator and a juror. A backer can still serve if selected under the ordinary draw. The same numeric score against the same ruling has one shared position. Proposals use steps of 0.01 from zero to one; the final jury score keeps its own precision.

“Admission stays open for a bounded period. All admitted positions then share a funding deadline. Two fast funders cannot close admission early. Underfunded positions receive full refunds. If no position fully funds, the referenced ruling stands. One funded position wins by forfeiture; at least two funded distinct positions share a larger jury.

“Each contested level has one combined pot. It covers the jury-fee shortfall after the pool contribution. The net pot is divided by inverse distance to the ultimate final score; a unique exact prediction receives the whole net pot. Each position then pays its backers pro rata. A closer prediction can still lose money after fees and competition.

“Adjudicated backer pots wait until the whole appeal chain ends, and every level uses its ultimate final score. That lock is different from already-earned jury fees and beneficiary earnings.”

What if the jury fails to reach quorum?

“The intended threshold is valid, timely reveals covering at least 80 percent of the originally drawn voting weight. Missing reports do not make the denominator smaller, and there is no separate minimum headcount. A failed appeal attempt retries at the same planned size, without a fee for the failed attempt. Retries have no fixed limit while that protected appeal process remains eligible. A later appeal level doubles the previous ruling’s planned target; a retry does not double it again.”

Why does a numerical score not solve the judgment problem?

“The score records an assessment under a policy and supplies an input to a chosen allocation rule. It is not an objective unit of research quality or public benefit. The questions remain: does the policy ask for something worthwhile, is the evidence adequate, do assessors apply it well, and do the consequences help affected people?”

What happens to earned funds, holds and exits?

“Only new nominations face holdback before earning. A later score increase or decrease creates no new holdback and changes future earning when adopted under the ordinary finalization rules. Once beneficiary funding is earned, it is immediately

claimable, including during a claim challenge and after the nomination is debunked. A successful challenge closes the nomination, stops future earning and awards the submitter's deposit to the fact-checker. It does not take the beneficiary's past earnings.

"A request to withdraw the nomination is a different event. If made after a factual dispute starts, it waits behind that dispute. A successful challenge closes the nomination and cancels that queued exit. A rejected challenge allows the exit to proceed under the ordinary rules."

What if the nomination is edited?

"A jury and its appeals remain attached to the revision they assessed. Editing does not erase that funded contest or transfer its judgment to new content. A new revision needs its own adopted score for score-dependent funding. Previously earned money stays attributed to the earlier revision and remains claimable. Content identifiers establish which revision is being judged; they do not guarantee that its evidence stays available."

How do honesty, competence and scrutiny differ?

"Honesty means reporting sincerely. Competence means knowing how to judge the subject. Scrutiny means critically examining claims and evidence, including plausible alternatives. Willingness to examine a claim is different from having the expertise to assess it; an expert can also accept a claim without questioning it.

"Fees compensate service, not measured effort or expertise. Rewards and penalties aim to make informed judgment and critical scrutiny worthwhile. Private reports and agreement-based rewards are meant to make honesty a shared focal point, or Schelling point. The absence of collusion does not establish that truthful reporting is the only equilibrium or the most profitable strategy.

"Competence selection requires informed investigation to be profitable after effort and other costs, and to outperform a cheap prediction of the group's answer. A participant can predict others accurately without understanding the subject. Service fees can also outweigh token losses. Compare total returns, including both assets and effort, rather than treating agreement or a loss as a competence test.

"Losses reduce future draw chances only if available stake falls relative to competitors. Replenishment, outside wealth and changes in other jurors' stakes can change that outcome. The design does not guarantee that every weak assessor leaves."

What can we infer from the two coordination rounds?

“The seven-by-seven grid illustrates how several salient cues can support shared expectations. Among 48 odd numbers from 53 through 147, 100 sits in the center with a gentle blue tint. It is also the only even number and the only round hundred. Saying answers together lets us hear whether one choice is prominent; it does not produce reliable vote totals or a controlled test of which property caused the choice.

“The second round offers all eight combinations of honest or deceptive, competent or uninformed, and thorough or lazy. Honest, competent and thorough can become salient as a shared standard for how to play. Thorough here means critical scrutiny of claims and evidence. That illustrates contextual coordination, not a test showing that this conduct already maximizes returns in the curation mechanism.

“The arithmetic pattern is factual; matching the room still has no predetermined correct answer. Each revealed explanation describes the intended cue, not a tally. A cluster is an observation about this room, not proof of the proposed incentives. The design aims to make acting on honesty, competence and scrutiny rewarding; the exercise does not establish that result.”

[Optional historical context, for questions or a longer delivery: In Schelling’s 1957 sample, 36 people chose heads and six chose tails. Asked where and when to meet in New York, a majority chose Grand Central’s information booth, and almost everyone chose noon. Those results reflected a particular sample and its shared context, including the sample’s New Haven location.]

Source: Thomas C. Schelling, “Bargaining, communication, and limited war” (1957), note 1.

What can we infer from the points exercise?

“We can observe which reports earn points under this rule and discuss why participants chose them. The same reports produce the group result and its rewards, so the rewards do not independently establish honesty, competence and scrutiny. Even unanimous erroneous scores can earn rewards.

“The exercise gives each seat equal weight every round; accumulated point losses do not reduce later weight or draw chances. It does not model real capital at risk, costly information gathering, replenishment or stake-based selection. The short descriptions and prior knowledge also differ from a full evidence dossier.

“An assigned role is an instruction, not evidence that money caused manipulation. Discussion can affect later scores, and six different nominees are not six independent replications. Treat the results as observations for discussion, not a causal test of the

complete design.”

Does open participation mean that everyone is represented?

“No. People may lack money, time, relevant knowledge or access, and more deposited stake can carry more influence. Open entry removes an invitation requirement; it does not guarantee equal influence or representation of everyone affected.

“Choosing goals, judging evidence and representing affected people’s needs are different tasks. Democratic institutions can include expert advice and deliberation. This design is one proposed way to organize assessment, not proof that it replaces or improves upon democratic decision-making.”

Where does trust remain?

“The design distributes assessment and makes some judgments contestable. It still depends on the chosen criteria, accessible evidence, an external arbitrator and the implementation of its rules. We should ask what supports each dependency rather than describe the whole process as needing no trust.”

What would establish public benefit?

“First test whether the incentives improve assessment compared with a feasible alternative, using evidence of quality independent of the reward formula. Then test whether decisions based on that assessment improve outcomes for affected people, including costs, excluded needs and harms. Better prediction of the group, stable scores, private profit and faithful application of a policy do not by themselves establish that second result.”

Does this guarantee honest or sound judgment?

“No such guarantee has been established. The design tries to make useful assessment and correction worthwhile. Shared bias, coordination, poor policy and inaccessible evidence can still produce a bad outcome. We need separate evidence about reporting behavior, assessment quality, correction and downstream consequences. Profit and agreement alone do not supply it.”

What makes capture costly, and can the community recover?

“Acquiring enough of a dedicated utility token may be costly, and a visible capture may damage demand for the system and that token. Neither effect is a fixed security guarantee: liquidity, concentration, attacker motives and public recognition matter.

“The intended recovery path is voluntary forking. A group can choose whom to exclude and preserve the other balances; funders can choose whether to migrate their funds. Different groups may disagree about suspicion or which fork to follow. The practical requirements include a usable snapshot, migration tools and coordination. The capture and recovery discussion records the attribution and the limits of this response.”

What do these materials establish today?

“There is a research proposal, formal and simulated analysis with explicit limits, inspected implementation evidence, a proposed precursor experiment and a functioning teaching exercise. They do not yet establish that the integrated permissionless system reliably improves public outcomes. That is the work to test.”